

The Listing Audit: Your First Deliverable

Before an owner hires you, they need to see how you think. The listing audit is the deliverable that proves you can see the gaps in their current operation without having to ask them. This module walks you through the 15-point audit that has won us 70%+ of audit-to-contract conversions.

When to use the audit

The audit is your second conversation. The first conversation is the discovery call — you listen, you ask questions, you write down specifics. Within 48 hours, you deliver the audit as a one-page document or PDF. The audit is the proof that you actually looked at the property, not the owner's sales pitch of it.

The 15 audit points, in order

- 1. Listing title.** Under 60 characters, primary keyword first, no all-caps, no emoji.
- 2. Photo count and quality.** Minimum 25 photos. Hero shot is the kitchen or living room, not the exterior. Hero shot is taken at golden hour if possible.
- 3. Photo order on each platform.** Airbnb, VRBO, Booking.com all prioritize photos differently. Your audit should call out which photo each platform puts first and whether it is the right one.
- 4. Description length and structure.** First 3 lines are the only ones visible without clicking. Use them for the property's strongest hook.
- 5. Review score and review velocity.** Review score matters. Velocity matters more. New reviews every 14 days is the threshold for continued algorithmic promotion.
- 6. Calendar sync between platforms.** Airbnb, VRBO, Booking.com, Furnished Finder. If the calendar is not synced, double-bookings are inevitable. Show the owner their actual gap.
- 7. Minimum-night stay rules.** Some markets require 2-night minimums on weekends. Some properties can move from 3-night to 2-night and increase utilization 15%. Be specific.
- 8. Instant-book setting.** Off = drives away 60% of lookers. On = accepts bad guests. The audit should tell the owner what their setting says about their risk tolerance.
- 9. Pricing strategy.** Pull the calendar for the next 60 days. Show base price, cleaning fee, weekend uplift, last-minute discount. Compare to the comp set.

10. Comp set. Three closest comparable listings within a 5-mile radius. Same bedroom count, similar amenities. Compare price, photos, reviews.

11. Cleaning and turnover. Who cleans, when they clean, what the checklist is. If the owner doesn't know, the audit should propose a checklist.

12. Maintenance response time. Average days from "guest reports issue" to "issue fixed". Owners don't usually track this; if they do, the answer reveals a lot.

13. Owner responsiveness. How long does the owner take to respond to YOUR questions right now? This predicts how the relationship will go.

14. City / county STR compliance. Is the property licensed? Permit number? Are short-term rentals even allowed in this zoning? Always check the city code; this is the highest-leverage clause in the contract.

15. Payout structure and trust accounting. Who holds the booking money. Which bank. Whether it is licensed trust accounting (required in some jurisdictions).

How to present the audit

One page. White background. Hostflow tokens. Three columns: audit point, current state (one sentence), recommended fix (one sentence, specific and fast). End with a single call to action: 15-minute call to discuss the proposed fixes and the engagement model.

Do not include revenue projections in the audit. They invite debate. The audit is the conversation about quality of work. Revenue comes after you have done 60-90 days of the work and have the receipts.

The follow-up cadence

- Audit delivered within 48 hours of discovery call
- 15-minute follow-up scheduled at the time of audit delivery (not pending)
- If the owner doesn't book the follow-up, send one nudge at 7 days, then stop
- If they do book, walk the audit row by row and listen for objections

Module 05 — Done. Module 06 covers guest-screening scripts — how to identify problem guests before they book.